Anti-Matter

King Geedorah feat. Mr. Fantastik

Song Companion Guide

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Full detail. A song has no plot to spoil, so no spoiler tier applies.

Anti-Matter: A Companion Guide

Quick Take

"Anti-Matter" is the lone single from King Geedorah's Take Me to Your Leader (2003), and it is the album's clear standout. King Geedorah is one of the many aliases of MF DOOM, the masked rapper-producer Daniel Dumile, and on this record he plays a three-headed space dragon studying humanity from orbit. The track itself is simpler than that setup sounds: a laid-back, braggadocious back-and-forth between DOOM and a guest called Mr. Fantastik, riding a soul loop and hard drums. It is worth your time for two reasons. First, it is a genuinely great rap song, regularly cited among DOOM's best paired performances. Second, it is the entry point to one of hip-hop's most durable unsolved mysteries: nobody knows who Mr. Fantastik is, and after two verses on two DOOM records he simply vanished. If you came for the music, you will stay for the puzzle.

The Track

"Anti-Matter" is track 8 on Take Me to Your Leader, a 3 minute 26 second cut released as the album's only single on a limited 7-inch on September 1, 2003. The album itself dropped June 17, 2003 on the UK label Big Dada. The credit list is a small joke in itself: it is a "King Geedorah" song, produced by "Metal Fingered Villain," and rapped by "MF DOOM" and "Mr. Fantastik." Three of those four names are the same person. Dumile built a career out of personas, and "Anti-Matter" quietly stacks three of them on one track.

The conceit of the song is a comic-book grudge match. Mr. Fantastik shares a name with Mister Fantastic, leader of the Fantastic Four, and DOOM takes his name and mask from that team's arch-nemesis, Doctor Doom. So the track plays as a metaphorical team-up of two characters who, in the source material, are sworn enemies. Critics have described it as a tag-team record, the two MCs rhyming off one another in a call-and-response built around the defiant hook, "No matter how hard they try, they can't stop us now." Albumism memorably pegged the chemistry as "an ultra laid-back version of EPMD."

There is no deep narrative or message here. "Anti-Matter" is a flex record, two skilled rappers trading boasts about craft, money, and the ability to slip past anyone trying to catch them. What makes it land is the contrast in deliveries, which the next sections get into.

The Sound

The beat is the connective tissue between this single and the monster-movie album around it. At its core is a loop of The Whatnauts' 1971 soul cut "Message From a Black Man," set over hard, slapping drums. DOOM produced it himself under his Metal Fingers alias, and the instrumental later surfaced, stripped of vocals, as "Sarsaparilla" on Metal Fingers' Special Herbs, Vol. 7 & 8 (2004), which is typical of how DOOM recycled and re-released his beats across projects.

> *"A mesmerizing blend of a droning bassline and an oriental guitar lick, exuding a cinematic aura reminiscent of a samurai epic."*
>
> Spectrum Culture, on the production of "Anti-Matter"

The detail that ties "Anti-Matter" to the King Geedorah concept is the movie audio. WhoSampled credits the track with clips drawn from the Godzilla universe, including dialogue tied to Godzilla vs. Gigan and the King Ghidorah roar from Invasion of Astro-Monster. The monster is not just a name on the album cover; DOOM splices the actual kaiju into the recording, so the mythology is audible. Inside his verse, DOOM even shouts "King Geedorah on the boards," pointing back at himself as the producer-monster running the beat.

The Lyrics and What Is Going On

Both MCs are in pure braggadocio mode, but they play it differently, and that difference is the whole appeal.

Mr. Fantastik is the sharper, punchier of the two. His verses are tight and quotable, full of imagery about skill, elusiveness, and stacking income from multiple directions. The standout couplet has him staying ahead of the law: "Feds try to creep me, somehow always miss me / Mister Fantastik put the busy in the bee." He reaches for a basketball metaphor to describe precision and clutch craft, name-checking Reggie Miller and Robert Horry, two players famous for cold-blooded shooting under pressure.

DOOM plays the looser, more abstract counterpart, and on "Anti-Matter" he is at the top of his game. His verse opens with a line fans love to quote: "Who is he? He need to get out more / Or either get outta here like some dang outlaw." Read in context, that "Who is he?" is almost certainly DOOM winking at the listener. He is introducing a collaborator nobody can identify, and the first thing he raps is a question about who the guy even is. It is an Easter egg buried in the song itself. The cosmic boasting ties back to the album: "From Venus to Mars, back to Earth, back to the X-P-O Satellite / It's showtime." It is space-villain swagger, delivered with the unbothered cool that makes DOOM DOOM.

A note on lyrics: full reproduction is copyright-restricted, so this guide quotes only the short, widely-cited excerpts.

The Mr. Fantastik Mystery

This is the part that keeps "Anti-Matter" alive in conversation two decades later.

Mr. Fantastik's entire confirmed body of work is two guest verses: "Anti-Matter" (2003) and "Rapp Snitch Knishes" from DOOM's MM..FOOD (2004). That second track became one of the most beloved songs in the whole DOOM catalog, and the hook is Mr. Fantastik's. A third, non-vocal reference shows up on MM..FOOD's "Deep Fried Frenz," where DOOM raps that he "first met Mr. Fantastik at a arms deal." And then nothing. No third verse, no interviews, no real name, no social media, no appearances on anyone else's records.

> *"Perhaps the biggest unsolved mystery in the history of rap music."*

DJBooth, on the identity of Mr. Fantastik

The theories, roughly from most to least credible:

The MIC Theory

The most widely held explanation is that Mr. Fantastik is another rapper from DOOM's orbit, pitch-shifted. The leading candidate is Rodan, a member of DOOM's Monsta Island Czars collective who had known him since the late 1980s; some fans argue the voices line up when slowed to around 90 percent speed. A variant points to fellow collective member Spiega. This theory is appealing because it keeps the mystery in the family and fits DOOM's documented habit of disguising voices and recycling personas.

The Pure Mathematics Theory

A widely circulated r/mfdoom post argues Fantastik is "Pure Mathematics," a childhood friend DOOM name-checks on his solo debut Operation: Doomsday.

The Euphon Theory

In 2017 a Reddit user proposed the guest was a different rapper literally named Mr. Fantastik, half of an obscure East Harlem duo called Euphon, and posted pitch-altered audio comparisons to make the case.

The Long Shots

A now-deleted forum claim named Count Bass D, a real DOOM collaborator, who has denied it. Other guesses with essentially no evidence include U-God, RZA, Madlib, Del the Funky Homosapien, and even 50 Cent and Jay-Z. One correction worth making, because it circulates: there is no verified link between any "Kurtis Carey" and Mr. Fantastik. The "Carey" name in DOOM lore belongs to Percy Carey, the real name of MF Grimm, who appears on this very album under a different alias. If you see "Carey" attached to Mr. Fantastik, it is a mix-up.

DOOM, characteristically, muddied the water rather than clearing it. In a 2003 interview he said Fantastik was a New Yorker who had moved to Atlanta before he did, a "baller" who took him to strip clubs. Around the same time he reportedly said Mr. Fantastik "no longer exists." DOOM was an unreliable narrator by design, so even those statements are suspect.

The most intriguing recent wrinkle came in November 2022, near the second anniversary of DOOM's death. An Instagram video surfaced of Mr. Fantastik delivering a freestyle tribute over footage of DOOM, with the line, "We had the best time creating beats and songs, a true love for this game, yeah you put me on." He revealed nothing, gave no interview, and said nothing beyond the verse. That tribute strongly suggests Mr. Fantastik is a real, separate person who genuinely knew DOOM and has chosen, even now, to stay hidden. With DOOM gone, a definitive answer is probably gone too. For a lot of fans, that is exactly how they want it.

The King Geedorah Concept

To appreciate where "Anti-Matter" sits, it helps to know what King Geedorah is. The name comes from King Ghidorah, the three-headed golden space dragon and recurring Godzilla

nemesis in Toho's monster films. The alias was born inside the Monsta Island Czars, a collective in which each MC took the name of a Toho kaiju. Take Me to Your Leader is the only full-length album DOOM ever released as Geedorah.

In DOOM's own words, "This whole album is Geedorah's alien perspective on humans." The record is built as a monster-movie concept album: an alien intelligence descends from deep space, observes humanity, and considers invasion. DOOM stitches in dialogue and clips from Godzilla films, Invasion of Astro-Monster (also known as Monster Zero), Star Trek, The Twilight Zone, Looney Tunes, anime, vintage commercials, and news broadcasts. King Geedorah is also DOOM's most production-forward alias. He raps on only 3 of the album's 13 tracks and otherwise functions as the composer scoring the film, which is precisely the structure that lets an unknown like Mr. Fantastik co-front the lead single.

"Anti-Matter" is one of the clearest places the concept becomes audible rather than abstract. The kaiju samples, the "King Geedorah on the boards" shout, the comic-book villainy of two Marvel-adjacent characters squaring off, and the title's own science-fiction ring all fold the single neatly into the alien-invasion frame.

Critical Reception

Take Me to Your Leader was well received and has aged into a critical favorite. Pitchfork gave it 9.0 out of 10. Tiny Mix Tapes and Muzik gave it perfect marks, Stylus an A, RapReviews 8.5, and Uncut four stars. AllMusic was the notable holdout at 2.5 out of 5. The album holds an 82 critic score and an 82 user score on Album of the Year. Over the years it has appeared on retrospective lists, including Rhapsody's best hip-hop albums of the 2000s and Complex's best one-producer albums of the decade, and Stereogum once ranked it the third-best DOOM album.

> *"It will excite you in a way most hip-hop projects just aren't able: It's not straining for credibility nor putting effort into being revelatory; it just is."*
>
> Mark Martelli, Pitchfork (9.0 / 10)

Within that album, "Anti-Matter" is consistently the most-praised track. Spectrum Culture flatly called it "the album standout" and "a pinnacle of this album." It earned its single status, and DOOM's verse on it is regularly cited among his strongest. In an album mostly made of short, instrumental-leaning collages, "Anti-Matter" is one of the few full two-MC rap songs, which is part of why it works as the album's front door.

Where does the album sit in the DOOM canon? A tier below the consensus big three of Madvillainy, MM..FOOD, and Operation: Doomsday, largely because DOOM himself is mostly absent as a rapper. But critics frame Take Me to Your Leader as the opening act of his most prolific stretch, the 2003 to 2004 run that also produced Vaudeville Villain, Madvillainy, and MM..FOOD, four albums in two years. It is the slept-on entry that hardcore fans defend.

What You Might Not Know

A few pieces of context that enrich the listen.

The album is almost entirely a one-man operation. Dumile wrote, recorded, arranged, produced, mixed, and mastered nearly all of it himself under the Metal Fingers production name, and many of its beats overlap with his instrumental Special Herbs series. Big Dada, the album's home, is the hip-hop arm of the UK electronic label Ninja Tune, which is why a quintessentially New York rapper put out a kaiju concept record on a British imprint.

MF Grimm is on this album, and the friendship behind it went badly wrong. MF Grimm, real name Percy Carey, appears on Take Me to Your Leader as "Jet-Jaguar," another Monsta Island Czars kaiju name. Grimm and DOOM were close from the early 1990s; Grimm helped finance and executive-produce DOOM's debut Operation: Doomsday, parts of which were recorded in his basement. After Grimm was released from prison in 2003, the relationship soured over money, specifically royalties Grimm felt he was owed. It escalated into dueling diss tracks: DOOM mocked the crew on "El Chupa Nibre," and Grimm answered with "Book of Daniel." The Village Voice quoted Grimm sounding more wounded than angry: "I consider him a brother to me, and it shouldn't have gotten to the point where it's at." For the record, this was a bitter feud and a royalty grievance, not a courtroom lawsuit. Grimm later told the whole story in his 2007 graphic-novel memoir, Sentences: The Life of M.F. Grimm.

The 7-inch is a collector's item. The original "Anti-Matter" single, backed with "I Wonder," became scarce and expensive enough on the second-hand market that the 2023 twentieth-anniversary reissue of the album bundled a fresh 7-inch specifically to make it available again.

If You Liked This

Five places to go next, each picked for a different thread you might be pulling.

"Rapp Snitch Knishes" (MF DOOM, MM..FOOD, 2004)	**The only other song Mr. Fantastik ever appeared on. The direct sequel to "Anti-Matter" and a fan favorite in its own right.**
Madvillainy (Madvillain, 2004)	DOOM's collaboration with producer Madlib, the album that tops most fan polls. The dense-rhyme, loose-loop aesthetic at its absolute peak.
Operation: Doomsday (MF DOOM, 1999)	DOOM's solo debut. The soulful sample-collage blueprint that the Whatnauts loop on "Anti-Matter" descends directly from.
Vaudeville Villain (Viktor Vaughn, 2003)	Released the same year under another DOOM alias. Grittier and rawer, frequently called his most underrated album.
The Unseen (Quasimoto, 2000)	Madlib rapping as his pitched-up alter ego. If the Mr. Fantastik voice-manipulation theory hooked you, this is that trick built into a whole album.

Going Deeper

If "Anti-Matter" sends you down the DOOM rabbit hole, three companions stand out. The Chronicles of DOOM: Unraveling Rap's Masked Iconoclast, by S.H. Fernando Jr. (Astra House, 2024), is the definitive recent biography, a 352-page account three years in the making. Dissect,

Season 12 (2024) devotes an entire analytical podcast season to DOOM, going line by line and beat by beat. And Did I Ever Tell You The One About... MF DOOM (2021) is a family-approved podcast series built from interviews with the people who actually knew him.

A closing note on legacy. Daniel Dumile died on October 31, 2020, from angioedema, a reaction to a newly prescribed medication. He was 49. His family did not announce it until December 31, and the news landed like a delayed shock. In the week after, streams of his catalog jumped 870 percent and Madvillainy re-entered the Billboard 200 at a new peak. Q-Tip's phrase, "your favorite rapper's favorite rapper," became the standard epitaph, and you can hear DOOM's fingerprints all over the generation that followed, most obviously in Tyler, the Creator and Earl Sweatshirt. "Anti-Matter" is a small piece of that legacy, but a sharp one, and the Mr. Fantastik question it left behind may be the most DOOM thing imaginable: a masked man, a hidden collaborator, and a puzzle with no answer key.

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